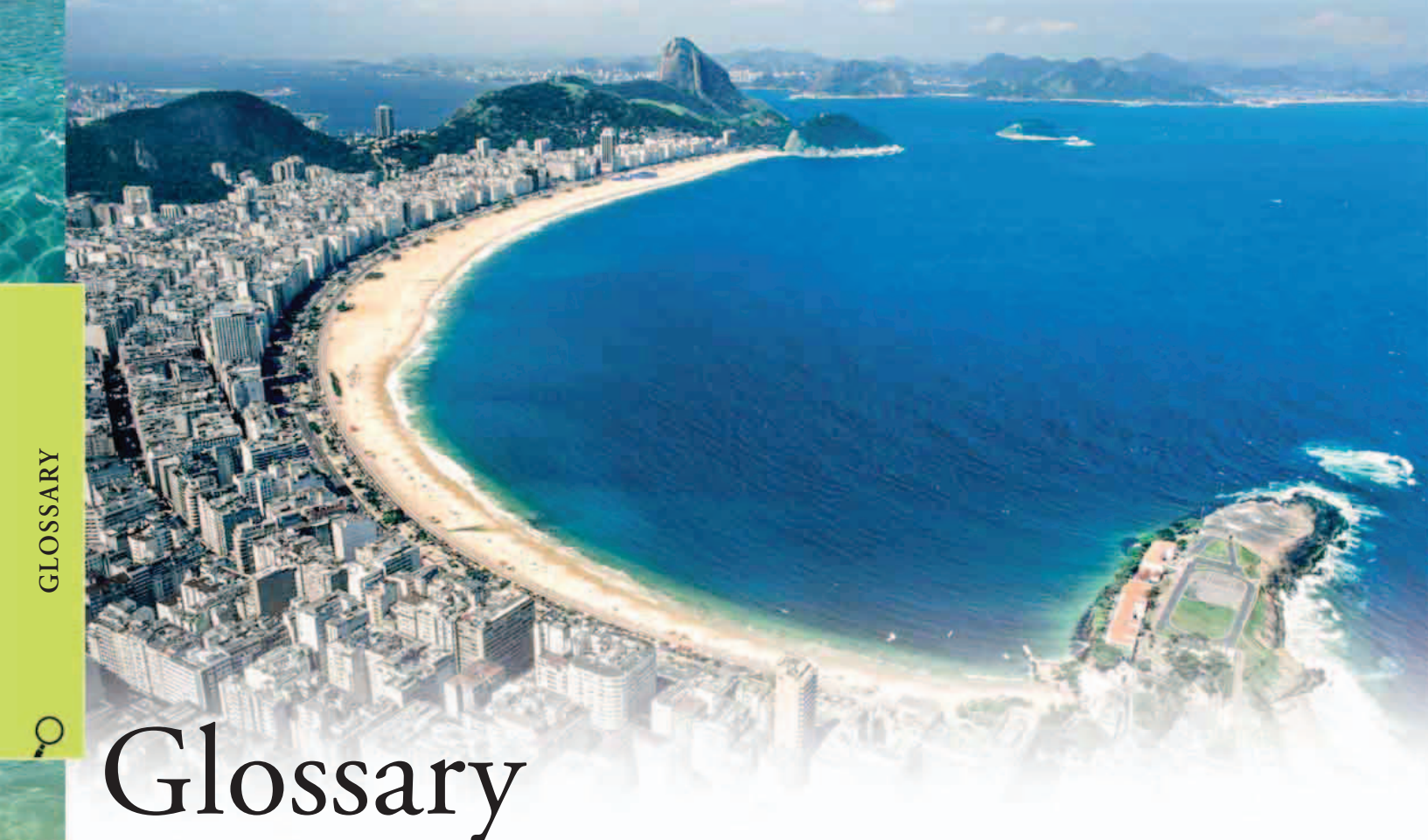




Glossary

Abyssal plain A flat area on the floor of the deep ocean, beyond the continental shelf, at a depth of 13,000–20,000 ft (4,000–6,000 m).

Algae Plantlike organisms that can make food using solar energy. Most algae are single-celled microbes, but they also include seaweeds.

Anemone A marine animal related to jellyfish that clings to a hard surface and uses stinging tentacles to catch food.

Antennae Long sensory organs that detect movement and sometimes chemicals in the water or air.

Archaea Bacterialike microscopic organisms that have a different biology, and form a separate kingdom of life.

Archaeology The study of human history by the scientific excavation and analysis of ancient remains.

Atoll A ring-shaped island, often formed from a coral reef based on a sunken extinct volcano.

Atom The smallest particle of an element, such as iron.

Auk A type of ocean bird such as a puffin, which uses its wings to swim underwater.

Bacteria Microscopic organisms with a simple single-celled form, and no distinct internal structures.

Baleen The fibrous material that certain large whales have in place of teeth, used for filtering small animals from seawater.

Barnacle A relative of shrimp and crabs that cements itself to a hard surface.

Basalt A dark, heavy volcanic rock that erupts as molten lava from oceanic volcanoes and forms oceanic crust.

Battery In biology, a group of organs with the same purpose, such as stinging cells.

Bedrock The solid rock that lies beneath more recent, softer material (sediments).

Bioluminescence A form of light produced by living things.

Bivalve A mollusk such as a clam with two shells joined by a hinge.

Buoyant Able to float.

Calving The process by which icebergs break off from the floating ends of glaciers.

Camouflage A pattern, body shape, or color that living things use to hide themselves from predators.

Carbon dioxide A gas naturally present in the atmosphere produced by the respiration of living things and by human activities, for example burning fossil fuels.

Cell The smallest unit of life. It can exist as a single cell, or form part of a more complex organism.

Cephalopod A type of mollusk, such as an octopus, with several sucker-covered arms and a relatively large brain.

Chalk A soft type of limestone rock formed from the skeletons of microscopic marine organisms (coccolithophores).

Chitin The substance that forms the tough external skeleton of a crustacean.